



GDD 01 Feelings Friends

Name it to tame it · every feeling, every kid

The first game, reworked to the new standard: built on real personas, one rich verb-set, and a researched library of 88 example scenarios so it is a feelings sandbox, never a wrapper. The Chapter 1 pilot that proves the bar.

The base of everything.

Feelings Friends is the first node a child meets, and the foundation the whole curriculum stands on: name your feelings, know they're all okay, learn to calm the big ones, read others', and learn that you can say no. It already exists and is one of the strong kids games; this rework lifts it to the new persona-and-research standard and sets the template for the other 68.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g01 · feelings (the stable id; node.game = GameDone key = registry id)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 1 · ages 3-6 · light canvas · parent co-played
Thread / topics	C · Feelings & Life Skills · UNESCO 5.2, 5.3, 5.6 (emotions, interpersonal, coping)
Gating	Core (the spine starts here)
Build status	Built & strong (tap/SEL + breathing Calm Corner + haptic Big No). This spec deepens content to the 80+ bar.
Teaches (toolkit)	Thread-C Cool-Down tool · THREAD_C_LEVEL feelings → 1

88	4	6	13	24
scenarios	verb-moves	categories	myths busted	feelings named

Three children, one adult in the room.

From the Chapter 1 personas. At 3-6 the parent co-plays, so the game must work for very different small players and for the grown-up holding the phone.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	WHAT THIS GAME DOES
Vihaan, 4 (bold, kinetic)	Movement and quick wins; a safe outlet for big anger.	Tactile "Big No", stomp-then-breathe calming, fast name-the-feeling rounds.
Aria, 5 (observer, people-pleaser)	Safe to be wrong; permission for "no" and anger.	No buzzers; explicit "anger is okay", "you can say no" scenarios for the good-girl trap.
Kabir, 5 (sensory-sensitive)	Calm, predictable, no overload; feelings made concrete.	Calm mode; the Calm Corner; literal naming; replay-friendly.
Megha (parent co-player)	Not a dopamine machine; a real conversation starter.	Co-play prompts; the gender-myth busts spark the talk she wants; sticker-only reward.
Educators	A 5-minute circle-time feelings tool.	Group-friendly naming and "how do they feel?" rounds.

The mission angle. Because this is The Equal Lens, the feelings game is also the first place gendered emotion myths get interrupted, early, where research says they form: "boys don't cry", "good girls don't get angry". 13 scenarios bust exactly these. Feelings are not a gender.

A feelings sandbox, not a quiz.

One coherent toy with four verb-moves (so it has the depth of the strong kids games, never the sameness of a wrapper). Each move maps to a scenario category, and the mechanic is the lesson.

VERB-MOVE	THE CHILD DOES	TEACHES	SCENARIOS
Name it (name-match)	Reads a situation, taps/says the feeling on a friendly face.	Self-awareness; affect labeling.	24 (name)
It's okay (all-okay reveal)	Meets a myth, learns the feeling is allowed (UN→RE).	All feelings okay; gender myths.	14 (all-okay)
Calm it (Calm Corner)	Picks/does a calming move; breathes with Lensy.	Self-management; Cool-Down tool.	16 (calm)
How do they feel? (empathy)	Reads a friend's face/situation; chooses a kind act.	Social awareness; empathy.	16 (empathy)
Big No (assertion)	Says/taps a Big No with a satisfying haptic.	Boundaries; the consent seed.	10 (big-no)
I can help (relationship)	Chooses what to do for someone's feeling.	Relationship skills; Help-Map.	8 (help)

No two moves are the same interaction; the session rotates them so a child never meets the same beat twice running. This is the palette rule from the strategy bible, applied.

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun?

Warm and reactive: expressive feeling-faces that pop, Lensy and Sam as companions, a Calm Corner you actually breathe with (the flower-and-candle breath), the tactile, satisfying "Big No", silly moments, and constant variety across the four moves. Short, complete rounds for a 3-6 attention span, with calm mode for Kabir and co-play prompts for the grown-up.

Is it teaching?

Yes, and the play is the learning. Naming a feeling literally calms the brain (affect labeling: naming lowers amygdala activity and engages the thinking brain). The child practises the full CASEL set in miniature: self-awareness (name it), self-management (calm it), social awareness (how do they feel?), relationship skills (I can help), and the first responsible-decision seed (Big No).

The belief it moves. From "some feelings are bad / boys don't cry / big feelings should be hidden" → "every feeling is okay, for every kid, and I have ways to handle the big ones." That shift, made at 3-6, is the base the other 76 nodes build on.

No wrapper here.

The anti-wrapper bar, met and exceeded: 88 researched scenarios, each a real 3-6 moment tied to a feeling or skill, a persona, a verb-move, and (where relevant) a myth it busts. The full, build-ready library is the companion JSON; here is the breakdown and a representative sample.

CATEGORY	COUNT	WHAT IT COVERS
Name the feeling	24	A broad emotion range: happy, sad, angry, scared, jealous, embarrassed, proud, shy, lonely, nervous, curious, calm, and more.
All feelings are okay	14	Normalising every feeling, including the gender myths (boys cry; girls get angry; men cry).
Calm the big feeling	16	Belly breath, candle breath, count to five, calm corner, name-it, squeeze-and-release, ask for a hug, take a break.
How do THEY feel?	16	Reading faces and bodies; perspective-taking; the kind response.
The Big No	10	Saying no, changing your mind, the uh-oh feeling, your body is yours (the consent seed).
What can I do?	8	Comfort, include, say sorry, share, find a trusted grown-up (Help-Map).

SITUATION	MOVE	RELEARN / TRUTH
A boy scrapes his knee and cries; a kid says "boys don't cry".	It's okay	Everyone cries; feelings aren't a gender.
A girl is angry a game was unfair; "good girls don't get angry".	It's okay	Anyone can feel angry; anger shows us unfairness.
Aarav's block tower falls right before it's finished.	Name it	That huff is frustration; naming it helps it shrink.
A relative wants a big hug and you don't feel like it.	Big No	Your body is yours; "no thank you" is always okay.
You said yes to a game but now want to stop.	Big No	You can change your mind; yes can become no.
Your hands are tight fists with anger.	Calm it	Three slow belly breaths tell your body it's safe.
A classmate sits alone while everyone plays.	How do they feel?	They may feel lonely; you could invite them in.
Loud sounds upset you; someone says you're dramatic.	It's okay	Bodies feel differently; your feelings are real and okay.
A friend is crying and other kids giggle.	I can help	Kindness over giggles; check if he's okay.
The big feeling is fading but you're still shaky.	Calm it	Feelings come and go like weather; this one will pass.
A dad cries happy tears; a child wonders if dads cry.	It's okay	Grown-ups cry too, including dads; tears aren't weak.
You feel too big a feeling to handle alone.	I can help	Knowing your trusted grown-ups (your Help-Map) is a life skill.

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 01 Feelings Friends — Scenario Library.json](#) (88 records: situation · prompt · options · answer · relearn · myth · persona · mechanic · source).

What this game erases.

The myths struck on the canvas and rewritten as truths, each grounded in the research. These also feed the chapter's myth knowledge base.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
Boys don't cry.	Everyone cries; crying lets big feelings out.	No innate crying difference in young children; socialised later.
Good girls don't get angry.	Anyone can feel angry; it signals unfairness.	Gendered emotion socialisation research.
Some feelings are bad.	All feelings are okay; what we do with them matters.	CASEL; affect labeling.
Being angry means you're naughty.	Anger is a normal feeling; hurting others isn't okay.	CASEL self-management.
Keep big feelings inside.	Naming and sharing a feeling makes it smaller.	Affect labeling (name it to tame it).
Big kids are never scared.	Everyone feels scared sometimes; brave can feel scared.	CASEL.
You must hug someone if they ask.	Your body is yours; you can say no.	Body-autonomy / consent foundations.
Real men don't cry.	Grown-ups cry too, including dads.	Gendered emotion socialisation research.

The micro-loop.

Every round runs the strategy's core loop, short and complete:

1. **Hook.** Lensy/Sam poses a situation with a "wait... how does this feel?".
2. **Play.** One verb-move (name / it's-okay / calm / empathy / Big No / help), drawn from the library and rotated so beats never repeat.
3. **UN → RE moment.** On a myth scenario, UN erases the struck myth and RE writes the truth; the child does the motion.
4. **Apply.** One quick use (e.g., do the breath, say the Big No, choose the kind act).
5. **Sticker.** A feeling-face sticker drops into the book; on completion, GameDone records once and levels the Cool-Down tool.

Signature pieces kept and deepened: the **Calm Corner** (breathe-with-Lensy, the flower/candle breath, the only place that slows right down); the tactile **Big No** with a firm haptic; and co-play prompts that invite the grown-up in for two minutes, then hand back. Sam/Lensy host; warmth throughout; no timers, no fail.

Gentle, safe, for everyone.

- **Register.** Ages 3-6: short, vivid, warm; ask, never tell; pre-reader friendly.
- **Audio-first.** Every prompt narrated (the speak contract: strips emoji, fires onEnd with a length-based fallback so muted/offline runs still pace).
- **Calm mode & no fail.** Reduced motion/sound option (for Kabir and bedtime); a wrong tap becomes a gentle "let's look again", never a buzzer.
- **Co-play.** Optional grown-up prompts; the game works solo-supervised or together.
- **Safeguarding.** The "uh-oh feeling" and Big No route toward telling a trusted adult; Get Help is one tap away and is never scored; sensitive moments empower, never frighten ("it's never your fault").
- **Accessibility.** Colour never the only signal; large-button equivalent for every gesture; resizable text; offline; works on a budget phone.

Build-ready, contract-safe.

Written to drop into the existing pipeline without breaking anything (per the Build Reference).

- **gameld. feelings** — `node.game === the GameDone key === the engine-host registry id`. Do not rename.
- **Content as data.** The 88-scenario JSON is the content file (`content/games/feelings.ts` shape); deepening = edit the library, zero blast radius.
- **Schema note.** Each record: `id · cat · situation · prompt · options · answer · relearn · myth? · persona · mechanic · source`. If the build's current feelings content type is thinner, this is the extension to adopt.
- **Reuse vs bespoke.** Reuses `GameShell`, `GameDone` (records once), `juice`, `speak`, `Sam/Lensy`, the `UN→RE` beat. Bespoke: the four feeling interactions + the `Calm Corner`. Not on the shared `ModesEngine` (a genuinely distinct verb-set).
- **Toolkit hook.** Teaches/levels `Cool-Down` (`THREAD_C_LEVEL feelings → 1`); other games reference it via a non-blocking `ToolMoment`.
- **Generated path.** Any label/order/thread change flows through `master-node-table.xlsx` + `gen-path.py`, never hand-edited `path.ts`.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): no hard fail; never score safeguarding; Get Help everywhere; UN→RE with restraint at real misconception moments; wellbeing crisis-routing register; balance (real green flags, not only red).

Why this works.

The design and the scenarios are grounded in established evidence, not invented. Key anchors:

- **Affect labeling ("name it to tame it").** Naming a feeling engages the prefrontal cortex and dampens the amygdala, reducing intensity (Lieberman et al., "Putting Feelings Into Words"; Siegel & Bryson, *The Whole-Brain Child*).
- **CASEL five competencies.** Self-awareness, self-management, social awareness, relationship skills, responsible decision-making, emerging in the preschool years.
- **Emotion-regulation strategies.** Belly breathing, counting, calm-down corner, grounding, labeling, are evidence-based for preschoolers (Zones of Regulation; early-childhood regulation literature).
- **Gendered emotion socialisation.** No innate crying difference in young children; boys are socialised toward anger and away from sadness (and the reverse for girls) from preschool; the "boys don't cry" stereotype is learned, and worth interrupting early.

Full citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. This GDD is the pilot template; the other 68 follow the same ten-section shape, each with its own researched 80+ library.